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★★★★ \$5.00

DJIA 47909.92 ▲ 1325.46 2.85% NASDAQ 22635.00 ▲ 2.8% STOXX 600 613.50 ▲ 3.9% 10-YR. TREAS. ▲ 13/32, yield 4.290% OIL \$94.41 ▼ \$18.54 GOLD \$4,749.50 ▲ \$92.40 EURO \$1.1662 YEN 158.58

What's News

Business & Finance

- ◆ **Traders sent crude** futures to one of their largest one-day drops on record while the Dow rose 2.8%, logging its best day since April 9, 2025. The S&P 500 and Nasdaq rose 2.5% and 2.8%, respectively. **A1**
- ◆ **Most officials at the Fed's** policy meeting last month thought progress in taming inflation could be slower than expected, driven by three concerns, minutes show. **A4**
- ◆ **Jeff Shell resigned as** Paramount's president and is stepping down as a board member, the media and entertainment company said. **B1**
- ◆ **Meta Platforms** announced a new, closed large language AI model called Muse Spark and plans to release a private preview to a few partners via an API. **B1**
- ◆ **Delta reported its** first quarterly loss in nearly three years after the airline's fuel expenses rose by \$330 million and the values of companies in which it has a stake fell. **B3**
- ◆ **Cornerstone Building Brands** hired consulting firm AlixPartners to negotiate with creditors to restructure its nearly \$5 billion balance sheet. **B3**
- ◆ **CK Hutchison began** arbitration proceedings against Maersk after Panama seized its port assets there, escalating a dispute that began in January. **B3**
- ◆ **European companies** that list at home outperform peers that choose the U.S., according to a report that challenges a common, inverse assumption. **B10**
- ◆ **ByteDance's TikTok** is investing the equivalent of \$1.16 billion to build a second data center in Finland. **B4**

Worldwide

- ◆ **A two-week cease-fire** between the U.S. and Iran teetered as Israel launched massive attacks on Lebanon and Iran threatened to reverse its plan to open the Strait of Hormuz to traffic. **A1, A5-7**
- ◆ **The damage to key** Middle Eastern energy hubs will ensure a prolonged squeeze on global oil and gas markets even if the strait reopens. **A5**
- ◆ **The Trump administration** is considering a plan to punish some NATO members that the president believes were unhelpful to the U.S. and Israel during the war. **A6**
- ◆ **Jasveen Sangha**, the drug dealer behind the fatal ketamine trade that killed TV star Matthew Perry, was sentenced to 15 years in prison. **A3**
- ◆ **People with a common** gene variant lost more weight on GLP-1 weight-loss drugs than those without it, researchers reported. **A3**
- ◆ **Turkey detained** nine people as part of an investigation into an attack on police outside a building housing the Israeli Consulate in Istanbul. **A8**
- ◆ **Greece plans to ban** social media for children under the age of 15, joining other countries considering or enforcing restrictions to shield younger users from harmful content. **A8**
- ◆ **An attorney for a man** shot by Immigration and Customs Enforcement agents during an arrest in central California rejected the agency's allegations about his client. **A2**
- ◆ **Died: Davey Lopes**, 80, Los Angeles Dodgers All Star. **A3**
- ◆ **Jim Whittaker**, 97, first American to reach the summit of Mount Everest. **A2**

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Cease-Fire Teeters on Its First Day



Smoke rises from an Israeli airstrike on the suburbs of Beirut, as the U.S. and Iran disputed what was required in the cease-fire.

Gulf States Worry Two-Week Truce Left Iran Emboldened, Empowered

Allies say war's gains are overshadowed by Iran's leverage over Strait of Hormuz

By YAROSLAV TROFIMOV

DUBAI—The Iranian government hailed the cease-fire with the U.S. by posting images on social media of President Trump waving the white flag and collapsing on his knees in defeat. The U.S.'s allies and partners in the Middle East fear Tehran

might have a point—and that they will end up paying the price for a war in which the overwhelming military might of the U.S. and Israel failed to secure political gains. Subjected to thousands of Iranian missile and drone strikes since the war's start, the Gulf states are grappling with how to survive next to an emboldened Iran that, as of now, retains control over the Strait of Hormuz. "Iran is the only one that is happy with the outcome. They have now been re-established as the policeman of the Gulf,"

said Mohammed Baharoon, director-general of the B'huth Dubai Public Policy Research Center, a think tank in the United Arab Emirates. "We woke up to a deal that doesn't reduce the risk, but instead replaces it with a bigger risk." To be sure, Iran's Islamic Revolutionary Guard Corps has sustained heavy losses, including much of its leadership, and the two-week cease-fire doesn't mean an end to fighting. Officials in the Middle East believe there is a significant chance the war will flare up again—possibly with greater

intensity. The region's future is slated for discussion by the U.S. and Iran at talks Friday in Islamabad, Pakistan. "It's important to keep things in perspective. This is a temporary two-week cease-fire. This is not a deal," said Hamad Althunayyan, a political analyst and professor at Kuwait University. "We could see an extension of that deadline, but we could also see a return to hostilities." The speed with which Trump went from threatening Tuesday morning that "a

Iran threatens to keep strait closed in response to Israeli strikes on Lebanon

A two-week cease-fire between the U.S. and Iran was on tenterhooks Wednesday, as Israel launched massive attacks on Lebanon and Iran threatened to reverse its plan to open the Strait of Hormuz to traffic.

By Saleh al-Batati, Feliz Solomon and Omar Abdel-Baqi

Both the U.S. and Iran claimed victory on Wednesday after both countries agreed to a cease-fire to end the war that began in late February, but Iran continued to fire missiles and drones at Arab countries in the Persian Gulf and Israel unleashed a barrage of deadly strikes against Hezbollah militants in Lebanon. Iran's parliamentary speaker, Mohammad Bagher Ghalibaf, accused the U.S. on X of several key violations of his country's 10-point framework to end the war. These breaches, he wrote, make both the cease-fire and negotiations for a long-term peace agreement effectively meaningless. "From the outset, we followed the ongoing process with distrust, and as expected, the United States once again violated its commitments even before negotiations began," he wrote on Wednesday.

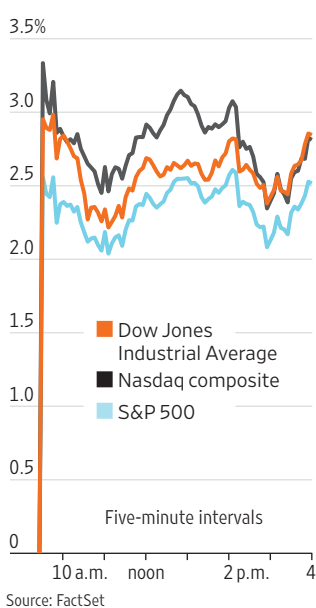
President Trump said on Tuesday that the U.S. and Iran agreed to a two-week pause in fighting, conditional on the immediate reopening of the strait, while pointing to progress on a

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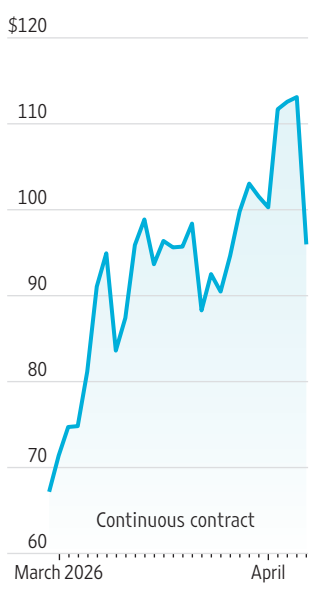
Financial fallout

- ◆ **Truce can't undo region's** energy hangover..... **A5**
- ◆ **Oil CEOs have profited** during Iran conflict..... **B1**
- ◆ **Heard on the Street: TACO** trade gets stale..... **B11**

Index performance Wednesday



Crude oil futures



Peace Deal Sends Stocks Up, Drives Oil Into a Sharp Drop

A historic plunge in oil prices. A soaring stock market. A Treasury rally. They all arrived Wednesday—despite missiles and drones continuing to fly across the Middle East.

By David Uberti, Hannah Erin Lang and Jared Mitovich

For weeks, pressure has built on Wall Street for a post-war rally that no one wanted to miss. Stock pickers hung on President Trump's every word

for signs of de-escalation. Shorts on crude futures and energy stocks piled up. The U.S. and Israeli cease-fire with Iran on Wednesday kicked many of those trades into high gear, even as the outlook for skyscraper-size tankers of oil and gas transiting one of the world's energy chokepoints remains unclear. As traders sent crude futures to one of their largest one-day drops on record, the Dow Jones Industrial Average rose 2.8%, or around 1,325 points, logging its best day

since April 9, 2025. "There was a kind of pent-up demand for a modicum of good news," said Phil Blancato, chief market strategist at Osaic. Investors on Wednesday didn't wait for signs of whether the cease-fire will hold or if ship traffic through the Strait of Hormuz picks up. Benchmark U.S. oil prices plunged 16%—a decline not seen since the depths of the pandemic—to \$94.41. At a time the price of oil

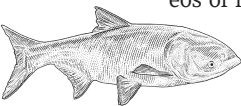
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Humans Are Losing the Fight Against These Highflying Fish

Asian carp have been crashing into boaters, doling out black eyes and broken noses

By JEANNE WHALEN

Clint Carter was enjoying the sunshine and gentle rocking of the boat when a 30-pound fish leapt out of the Louisiana water and smashed into his chest. The fisherman was bruised but not particularly surprised. It wasn't his first encounter with a beast that has become the Heartland's most vicious invader. Asian carp have



Large-scale conflict

Asian carp have taken over the Mississippi River and dozens of tributaries, where they have menaced native fish by eating much of their food. They've also spent years terrorizing locals by leaping from the waves and crashing into boaters, water skiers and fishermen. "I've had them hit me in the arms and legs," says Carter, who recalls one bone

bruise on his shin that took weeks to heal. On one outing near Carter's home in central Illinois, a flying carp knocked his friend out cold. "It actually hit him between the eyes, dropped him to his knees," he recalls. Another friend had his nose broken. YouTube is awash with videos of freaked-out Midwesterners battling the meaty fish from their boats. According to the U.S. Geological Survey, the carp can jump as high as 10 feet into the air when spooked by outboard motors or other disturbances. Politicians in Michigan and Illinois are pushing for help to build barriers and blast annoying sounds to repel the fish. Meanwhile, boaters are taking matters into their own hands. When Nate Wallick takes

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INSIDE



U.S. NEWS
New York architect accused in Gilgo Beach serial killings pleads guilty to murder. **A3**



SPORTS
The 45-year-old major champion defying his age at the Masters. **A12**

The Sea and Neighbors Are Angry on Nantucket

By KRIS MAHER AND GRETCHEN TARRANT GULLA

SIASCONSET, Mass.—A vandal is at large on Nantucket, an island better known for gray-shingle cottages, boat shoes and billionaires. In January, someone apparently slashed a 947-foot-long structure of sand-filled tubes, designed to slow erosion of scenic Sconset Bluff. The damage to the project—on which homeowners spent about \$18 million, and could cost another \$2 million to repair—has inflamed a battle between people trying to save expensive summer homes teetering on the bluff's edge and year-rounders who have said nature should take its course. "It's shocking," said Josh Posner, president of the Sconset Beach Preservation Fund. The group is trying to protect 80 houses on Baxter Road, an enclave with spectacular ocean views and named properties such as "Owl's Nest." Members of the Hearst and

Soros families own homes there, along with legendary commodities trader Helmut Weymar and Amos Hostetter, a Boston-based billionaire and philanthropist. Erosion fights are raging on coastlines nationwide as sea-level rise and intense storms devour beaches and prime real estate. Few have been as entrenched as Nantucket's. The dispute involves lawsuits, testy town meetings and talk of class conflicts. Lifelong friends now find themselves on opposing sides, with one faction even accusing the other side of engineering a political purge of the island's conservation commission. And now, ahead of a May town meeting that could decide whether the homeowners can expand the geotubes project to protect more homes—someone or something has struck. The Nantucket Police Department, which launched a probe, is considering all pos-

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